

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Nuclear detonation

CHEMICAL RADIATION / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

After a nuclear detonation, get inside the nearest sturdy building as quickly as you can. Move to a basement or central interior area, away from walls, windows, and the roof. Stay inside and tune to official updates; the first 24 hours are especially important unless the building is unsafe or authorities direct you elsewhere.

Do now.

- ☐ **Get inside**
01 Do not remain outdoors looking at the blast or travel across town for a preferred shelter. A substantial building offers better protection than a vehicle or open space.
- ☐ **Go deeper inside**
02 Use a basement or the middle of the building with as much material between you and outdoors as possible. Close doors and windows.
- ☐ **If exposed outdoors, clean up**
03 Once sheltered, remove the outer layer of clothing and set it aside away from people; wash exposed skin with water and soap when available. This reduces contamination brought indoors.
- ☐ **Stay tuned**
04 Use radio, phone, or other available channels for location-specific instructions. Avoid going out to collect family members who are already sheltered elsewhere.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Do not leave protective shelter simply because broadcasts fail. Use an intact basement or central space, keep contaminated outer clothing away from people and use covered water and food. Fire, collapse or another immediate life threat can force a move; a timer alone cannot establish safe outdoor conditions.

Watch for.

Fallout conditions vary by place and time. Do not treat a fixed distance or a clock as an all-clear; use the official instructions for your location. Potassium iodide is not a general radiation antidote and should be taken only when public-health officials advise it.

People & practical needs.

Keep the family together in the correct shelter for the hazard and separate potentially contaminated items from the living area. Use covered food and safe water

Next decision.

Arrange water, medications, and a way to receive alerts within the shelter. Leave only for an immediate threat such as fire, collapse, or other life-threatening condition, or when officials direct a safe move.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

CDC · Radiation emergencies

CDC · Get inside

CDC · Stay inside

EPA · Radiation emergency preparedness

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/nuclear-detonation/>